

Erasmian Koine Greek Alphabet

Companion chart to the audio guide. Seminary / academic Erasmian — distinct letter sounds for spelling, not first-century speech (which is closer to Modern Greek).

Letters

Letter	Name	Say the name	Erasmian sound
A α	Alpha	AL-fuh	ah — father / car
B β	Beta	BAY-tuh	b — bat
Γ γ	Gamma	GAM-uh	g — get; ng before γ, κ, χ, ξ
Δ δ	Delta	DEL-tuh	d — dog
E ε	Epsilon	EP-sih-lon	eh — bet
Z ζ	Zeta	ZAY-tuh	dz — adze / kids
H η	Eta	AY-tuh	ay — they / late
Θ θ	Theta	THAY-tuh	th — thin / theology
I ι	Iota	eye-OH-tuh	ih / ee — pit / machine
K κ	Kappa	KAP-uh	k — kite
Λ λ	Lambda	LAM-duh	l — lamp
M μ	Mu	MYOO	m — man
N ν	Nu	NOO	n — net
Ξ ξ	Xi	KSEE	ks — axe / fox
O ο	Omicron	AH-mih-kron	short o — pot / log
Π π	Pi	PIE	p — pet
P ρ	Rho	ROE	r — red (slightly trilled)
Σ σ ς	Sigma	SIG-muh	s — sit (ς only word-final)
T τ	Tau	TAOW	t — top
Υ υ	Upsilon	OOP-sih-lon	ew / ü — few / German ü
Φ φ	Phi	FIE	f — phone
Χ χ	Chi	KYE	kh — loch / Bach
Ψ ψ	Psi	PSEE	ps — lips
Ω ω	Omega	oh-MAY-guh	oh — bone

Diphthongs

Spelling	Made of	Erasmian sound
αι	alpha + iota	eye — aisle
ει	epsilon + iota	ay — eight / they
οι	omicron + iota	oy — oil / boy
υι	upsilon + iota	wee — suite
αυ	alpha + upsilon	ow — how / sauerkraut
ευ	epsilon + upsilon	ew — feud / few
ηυ	eta + upsilon	ew — feud
ου	omicron + upsilon	oo — soup / food

Notes. Gamma is *ng* only before γ, κ, χ, or ξ (e.g. **■**γγελος = ANG-geh-los). Iota subscript (**■ ■ ■**) does not change the sound. Rough breathing (**■**) adds an initial *h*; smooth breathing does not. Accents mark stress, not pitch, in this system. Audio file: erasmian_koine_greek_alphabet.mp3 (~3:09).